



12-14-2021 MCS Board Meeting - Work Session

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ucn9lxCiQio
Publication Date	2021-12-15T10:55:52Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muncie Community Schools Board Work Session

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or separate pre-meeting committee session was held prior to the call to order; the meeting opened directly into a board work session.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officers and board members convened a board work session to discuss student and teacher mental health services, upcoming semester initiatives, and ongoing systemic challenges.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Board members and administrators (including Leanne, Brittany, and staff from Meridian Health Services).
 - **Absent:** Not explicitly noted in the transcript.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Lead board member / chairperson conducting the discussion.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The transcript begins mid-proceedings or moves directly into the substantive work session without recording an explicit invocation or Pledge of Allegiance. Holiday greetings were exchanged near adjournment ("Merry Christmas everybody").
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed or acted upon in this excerpt.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:06:22 Work Session Presentation: Meridian Health Services & District Mental Health Support**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representatives from Meridian Health Services (including Lisa) and district leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board and presenters engaged in an extensive work session discussion regarding teacher and student mental health, post-COVID transition struggles, increasing clinical volumes, and the strain on school counselors. Presenters outlined the "Five T's" of mental health education in schools (Talking about mental illness, Training teachers/staff, Teaching students, Tools/mindfulness, and Taking care of teachers/workplace wellness).
 - Discussions also covered the expansion of Meridian clinics into East Washington Academy and South View starting January 3rd, the availability of Mental Health First Aid (MHFA) and trauma-informed care training, and barriers to participation such as teacher burnout, heavy workloads, and a severe shortage of substitute teachers. Board members emphasized the need for a systemic, proactive strategy heading into the second semester to address educator burnout and student learning loss.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (board work session format).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational work session; no formal vote or resolution was taken on this item.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No open public comment period or floor remarks from general residents were recorded during this session; discussion was restricted to board members, administrators, and invited presenters.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Expansion of Meridian health services and nursing staff into East Washington Academy and South View effective January 3rd.
 - Distribution of Meridian magazine highlighting the South Side school clinic.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following a motion to adjourn and closing holiday wishes (00:53:33). Exact adjournment time was not explicitly stated.
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